Zürcher Hochschule
für Angewandte Wissenschaften

Rektorat

Ressort Internationales

Accommodation possibilities for Incoming Students – How to find somewhere to live

This document contains information and tips for incoming students at the ZHAW who are looking for somewhere to live.

1. Student Housing Cooperative

WOKO (Studentische Wohngenossenschaft Zürich) offers inexpensive accommodation for students. Link to WOKO

If you are interested in WOKO accommodation, please notify the ZHAW Registrar's Office as soon as you are accepted as a visiting student. There are a limited number of housing possibilities and the "first come, first served" principle applies. Registration is binding; in the case of withdrawal, costs will be incurred.

2. Searching independently

There are a limited number of rooms and flats on the market and there is a lot of competition, so you should start searching well in advance, check for new additions on a daily basis, and apply immediately.

Don't limit your search to the centres of Winterthur and Zurich. Many smaller towns and villages are only half an hour away on public transport, and it often costs less to rent places outside the city centres. You can check the distance to the ZHAW by going to sbb.ch, zvv.ch or map.search.ch

2.1 Websites where you can search for accommodation

Student accommodation

http://www.students.ch/wohnen
http://www.studentenwohnen.ch
http://www.wohnen.ethz.ch
http://www.marktplatz.uzhalumni.ch/de
http://www.dachlade.ch
http://www.juwo.ch
https://www.loge71.ch
https://loge21.ch/

https://flatfox.ch/de/wohnung/neustadtgasse-29-8400-winterthur/72436/

Barrier-free accommodation:

www.procap-wohnen.ch

Rooms in shared flats

http://www.wg-zimmer.ch

Property portals

http://www.homegate.ch
http://www.immoscout24.ch
http://www.alle-immobilien.ch
https://immo-klip.ch

2.2 Newspapers and notice boards

Once you are in Switzerland, it is worth checking the notice boards of local universities (ETH, University of Zürich, ZHAW).

Advertisements in newspapers are also a good source. Almost all local papers publish accommodation advertisements on a regular basis. The most well-known newspapers in the Winterthur and Zurich area are: “Der Landbote”, “Winterthurer Zeitung”, “WOZ Die Wochenzeitung”, “Zürcher Unterländer”, “Tagblatt der Stadt Zürich”, “Tages-Anzeiger” and the “Neue Zürcher Zeitung”.

Rooms in shared student flats rarely appear in newspapers and can usually be found on notice boards at the universities.

It is not always easy for foreign visiting students to rent a flat of their own. Sometimes residency permits, deposits, contractually agreed renting periods, etc. are demanded.

2.3 Networking

Use your own personal contacts with colleagues or other students, even before you arrive in Switzerland. Ask students in your home country who have been in Switzerland for help before you come, for example.

Student organisations such as ESN or Alias ZHAW might be useful too. And there are also ZHAW students who want to rent out their own accommodation while they are studying abroad.

2.4 Homestays

Students who wish to experience Swiss lifestyle, culture and language by living in a family should consider homestays. The following platforms offer assistance in finding a suitable host family:

http://www.homestayweb.com
http://www.worldhomestay.com
http://www.workaway.info
https://www.couchsurfing.com
http://homestaybooking.de

3. ZHAW emergency number

If you find yourself in a threatening situation during your stay, or if you witness such a situation, please call the ZHAW emergency number: +41(0)58 934 70 70 (round the clock). Detailed information can be found at: https://www.zhaw.ch/en/about-us/emergencies/.

4. Issued by

The original German version of the guidelines can be found here:
Z_RL_Richtlinie_Open_Access_Publikationsfoerderung.pdf

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